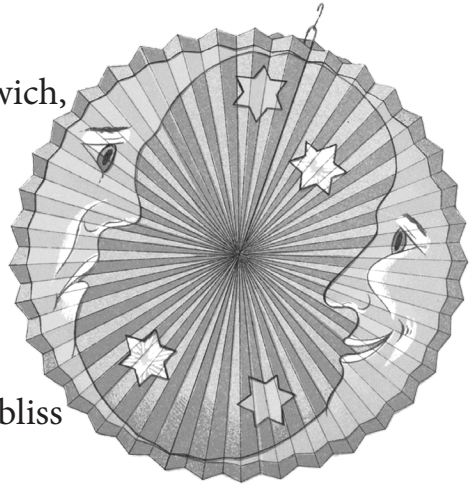
Poem

Sean Toomey

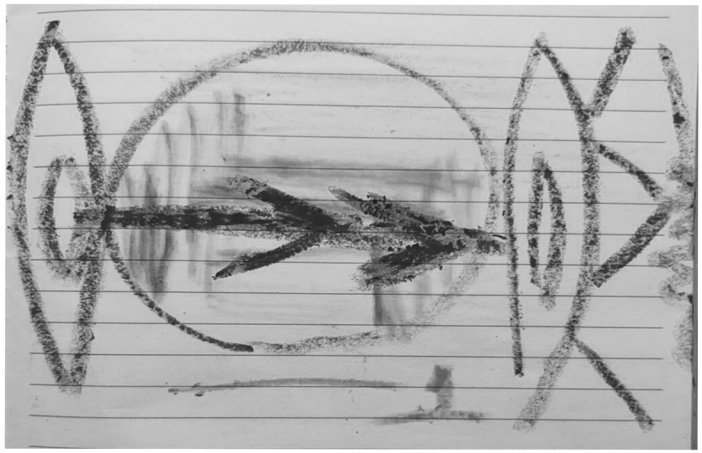
I stopped her pacing in the rain
And asked if there was wisdom on the other side:
Did you learn anything, or just get wet?
Before she could answer,
Devil kids ran past forgotten men singing off key,
And the rain kept falling down, right on me

Is it wrong to weep
When pain kills all mystique
Shiny asphalt, shady city, steel sandwich,
Ten towels for me, a torrent for you,



First degree burns on my lips,
Steaming manhole, our first kiss
God willing, I forgot how to speak,
Already remembering his dry heat
Full force frontal lobe assault,
The fleeting high, the synchronized bliss
No way to live, lost in all this

Circling, circling, spinning the block
Two bodies caught in gravity's lock
Wet sock arsonists under fogged-in ghettos
Dreaming of lazy days in the celestial meadow
Watching true love collapse into its final form:
The neutron star or the black hole, they are reborn



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N. 3

LUNCH IN HELL

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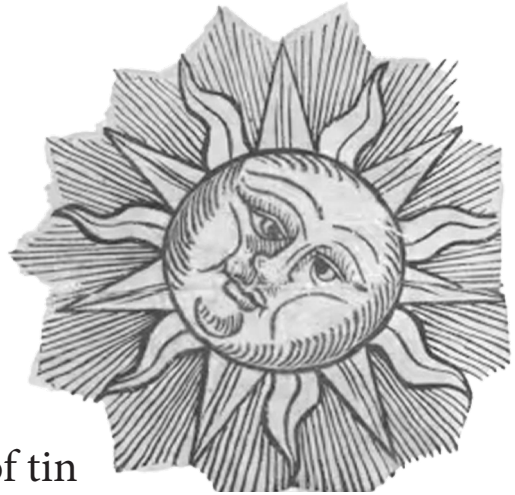
Saturday 19 of April 2025

Rainy Days

NOTE:
There was once a hand drawn sketch here!
Our friend davids drew on every copy by hand.
One time he taped a tea bag here.
He was so cool

Bricks

Simon Sepulveda



Bricks surround you
Bricks enclose you
Bricks hug you
And bricks sorrow you

So maroon, with hints of tin
Tin, spotted in your lines and body
Your body, so specific and righteous
Righteously loving my sins

So green, casually contrasting life
Life and your power to entail so quickly
Quickly growing among dried dreams
Dreamingly breaking their spine and roots

Your pores reminds bricks of mortality
Your palms engross bricks into a speckle
Your lips hunt bricks out of the grain
You make bricks into life

No Workers in the Workers' Party

Sean Toomey

On one particularly cold Sunday in Crown Heights, one hundred of Brooklyn's hippest have assembled together in a ken-do club to discuss some of the most pressing matters of our time. The crowd, seated between a powwow drum and a hand-painted banner that reads ***PEOPLE OVER PROFIT***, skews young and white. They stir when a young woman rises to address them: "Comrades" — a pause — "we finally bought a podium!"

Today's points of discussion at the Party for Socialism and Liberation include practical tips to prepare for deportation (buy a storage unit) and the federally mandated shutdown of a gay social club at Google. There is no doubt in my mind that many of my fellow comrades arrived here today in Ubers. As one boy takes to the stand, the ***PEOPLE OVER PROFIT*** sign falls to the ground because it was hung with scotch tape. Is this the "radical left" that keeps conservatives up at night?

There is a single, hopeful moment: a young tech worker addresses the crowd, seeking advice from unionized workers. Teamsters and District Council men snap to attention as he announces his mission to wrestle some power away from his billionaire CEO. He wants to start a union.

The Party for Socialism and Liberation has passion (often misdirected), aspiring politicians (kids with good hearts), and a brand new podium. It may be the party for you.

We Were Watching a Pillar of Matches

Jessy Ye

The Dying Machine Operator
operates on me

my heart spinning with the guilt
of losing a guitar pick

I don't know how to say I'm sorry
to an Admiral in the Spring

the damp grass stains my mouth

without words,

I can hear my breaths morethanithink

More often when I'm in your touch, I see
the man less frequent

Only now the machine will lay
in parts, scattered across the brink

He'll show up later,

engulfed,

flame after flame.

Epitaph To a Last Summer

Charles Misonne

When the air grows warm

And when the trees grow green

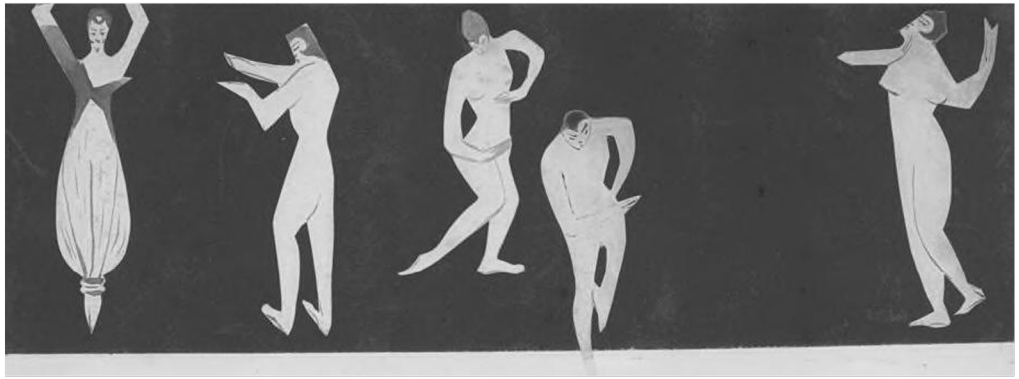
I look behind me and find

How youthful and naive

He was

When summertime last showed its leaves.

If You Were Within Reach

Jessy Ye

If you were within reach
I would smooth out the pattern
in the carpet beneath you, and
brush the hair from off your chest
take the paper cut from you,
and hug it with my hand;
I would pull my eyes to your
ears and pray to see,
a reservoir of june-bugs
swimming in a wide Sargasso Sea.